

**Regular Meeting
Monday, April 8, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:09PM.

Approval of Minutes of April 1, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion granted.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 affirmative

0 negative

Motion passes.

Report of Committees - Committee of the Whole - Capital Projects - Mayor Burke - Each item was voted on individually and approved. This will be presented to City Council. Ms.

DiBenedetto - The notes are not detailed enough. Mayor Burke - They are more detailed than they have been in the past. Ms. Van der Kloot - The gymnastics floor may be something to add to a capital plan. Concerns were raised by community members about the visual appeal of the high school. I would like to explore an additional sub committee to research improving the appearance of the high school complex. Mr. Ruggiero - Can we create a small scholarship for a design contest for students to present ideas for landscaping? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We can have students work on design, but may not be able to do a scholarship.

Motion to explore the scholarship for landscape design option and give a report offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Motion to send the topic to the Buildings and Grounds Sub Committee offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Motion to accept this report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Motion for suspension of the rules to take items 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6 out of order offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion granted.

Recognition of John Skerry, Recipient of the Robert S. Pierce Sportsmanship Coaching Award - Robert Maloney - The nominations for this award come from officials, which is a true testament to John's professionalism and leadership for Medford High School. Mr. Skerry - It is truly an honor to coach your hometown team. I am most proud of our students, National Honor Society, college-bound, active in community service. Most importantly, we turn out good citizens. Motion to accept and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Donation of an iPad and \$150 for a math student and to support the McGlynn Middle School Drama Club - Nicholas Tucci - The Fitzpatrick family has been very generous to Medford and we are grateful to them. Mayor Burke - Please thank the Fitzpatrick family for their donation.

Motion to approve the donation of an iPad offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

Motion to approve the donation of \$150 to the McGlynn Middle School Drama Club offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Donation of a Chair to the Columbus Elementary School - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Grant Funding for Composting Project at Medford High School - Curtis Tuden - Four students took initiative to begin this program. Special thank you to the CCSR and the Krystle Campbell Memorial Foundation. Finally, thank you to the Captain Planet

Foundation. The students who came up with this idea and implemented it are here tonight: 11th grader Ebyan Abshir, 11th grader Rachel Klein, 11th grader Audrey Soule, and 11th grader Cadee Stefani. Mr. Ruseau - How do you plan to get the weight composted and the carbon pollution offset? Mr. Tuden - We get full reports from the company on how much is composted by weight. Based on materials you can calculate the carbon offset. Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Motion to revert to regular schedule offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent - This past Saturday was the Medford Family Network's gala event Night of 10,000 Lights. Congratulations to Marie Cassidy for receiving a Tufts University Honorary Degree.

Congratulations to Shannon Demos, Assistant Principal of Brooks Elementary who won a seat on the Tewksbury School Committee.

Congratulations on the Medford High School Drama Club production of Fame, it was sold out every night and the audiences raved.

Brooks Elementary School hosted their Viva Variety Show this past Friday and Saturday night.

On April 11th at 6:30PM the McGlynn Middle School will host "Navigating the Cyber World" for all parents to attend.

MIDE Engineers visited the McGlynn Middle School.

Medford High School students raised over \$2,000 for Bring Backpacks to Baltimore and they were featured on Channel 4 WBZ News.

On Saturday, April 13th at 9:30AM the Medford High School Girls Softball team will host the Krystle Campbell Memorial Tournament at Columbus Park. The games are at 10AM and 1PM.

CCSR Program Fair dates:

Columbus Elementary School - April 11th, 5:30PM-7PM

Medford High School - April 25th, 2:30PM-4PM

Curtis Tufts High School - May 22nd, 9AM-11AM

Roberts Elementary School - May 23rd, 11:30AM-12:30PM

Andrews Middle School - May 30th during lunches

Brooks Elementary School - May 31st, 9AM-9:30AM

McGlynn Middle School - June 5th, 9:30AM-10:20AM

McGlynn Elementary School - June 6th 1:30PM

Building Bridges to Kindergarten will take place tomorrow at 7PM and the Parent Information Center will have extended hours from 3PM to 6PM for Kindergarten registration.

Thank you to the whole Medford Community for your support during my time of bereavement.

Mayor Burke - Special note that two students who attended our last meeting for the Enslaved Project have received another grant, congratulations to them.

Motion to approve report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Mr. Ruseau - I would like to confirm that MCAS results do not have to do with academic placement. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - It is not related to MCAS.

Report on Credit for Life Fair - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli - Thank you for attending the fair and to Kathy Kreatz for hosting a table. The goals of the fair are to learn about making real-world decisions about saving, spending, and budgeting money based on a host of career choices and lifestyle decisions. We hope for the event to continue in the coming years. Thank you to Lisa Evangelista for her outreach to the community to collect volunteers. All groups that contributed are listed on our blog. 310 students participated in this event. It was a very worthwhile event that we hope is deeply embedded in the tradition of Medford Public Schools. Mayor Burke - The students really got a lot out of it, it was very educational. Thank you to all involved. Mr. Ruseau - Is this in any budget proposals we will be hearing? Dr. Ricciardelli - I have talked to Mr. D'Alleva about including it in the high school budget. Assistant Superintendent Patterson is aware of it and sees its value. It cost roughly \$4,700 this year. I am hoping it will be included in the budget. Motion to receive report and place on file offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Name Change from Foreign Language Department to World Language Department - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli and Vilma Bibeau - It is important that we embrace the multiculturalism of this program by changing the name. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you for bringing this to our attention. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I requested a report on the number of students studying each language. Mayor Burke - That will be discussed in the budget meetings.

Report on the Status of the Gymnastics Facilities at Medford High School - Robert Maloney - Two areas of the gymnastics area were deemed "poor." The brackets for the bars and the floor. The report includes the quotes to upgrade. The floor will cost \$20,000. The space is open, it was deemed safe and it is okay to use. Mr. Ruggiero - Is there a risk children will be injured using the floor? Mr. Maloney - It is safe. There is less bounce on the floor so it is less safe. Mr. Ruggiero - How old is the floor. Mr. Maloney - 15 to 20 years. Ms. Kreatz - The report says we should resolve this before the next competitive season. Mr. Maloney - The next competitive season starts the day after Thanksgiving. Ms. Kreatz - We should add it to the budget or capital plan. Ms. Van der Kloot - I am concerned about the potential for injuries. This was not in our thinking when we did a capital plan. I think we need to include it as soon as possible in our budgetary planning. Motion to include this in the capital plan either year 1 or summer of year 2 offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Motion withdrawn.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Is it better to have it be in the capital plan or in the budget? I also asked for the rental income for the space. Mr. Maloney - This year the rentals are at 135. Last year it was 235 and the year prior it was 326. This year we are at a deficit of \$625. Last year we took in over \$10,000, the year before that was \$11,000, \$10,000 the year before, and \$3,000 the year before. We see bumps in registrations close to the Olympics.

Request of Ms. DiBenedetto that we keep a list of the materials so we do not drop the ball again. Motion to add \$20,000 to the athletics budget offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

Report on Superintendent's Entry Plan Findings. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The New Superintendent's Induction Program tasked me with completing this plan, as a portion of my first year as a Superintendent: listening, learning, and eventually leading. The list of school and community events I attended made it possible for me to listen and learn about the district. Administrative challenges occurred at the beginning of the school year. We received our finalized state results for testing to see where we stood. I had many opportunities to be in the schools to interact with staff and to meet elected officials. We dealt with media coverage at the beginning of the year. I have learned from interviews with school committee members and

school leaders what we have to address. I have learned from our negotiations with the unions, school visits, conversations with students, conversations with teachers, and conversations with community members. Every year we face a \$2 million deficit. It takes money to run a district well. Seeing solid teaching and engaged students energizes me. I have seen the really good bones of Medford Public Schools. I am ready and excited to move us to the next level. The work ahead of us is fine-tuning, improving, and challenging ourselves as a district. We have engaged in key work already, utilizing partnerships with Lesley University and Tufts University, working to improve equity, working to improve mathematics performance at the elementary level, working to improve reading and Response to Intervention for literacy. We have identified areas to improve, such as the elementary schools early release on Wednesdays, inadequate data systems, students social/emotional learning needs, weaker mathematics performance, different schedules between the general education and vocational technical education programs at Medford High School, and general emergency preparedness. I have spent this time listening and learning from colleagues and the community, and I am eager to continue leading this district into the future.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I applaud you for acknowledging where we are as a district truthfully. We are required to do a review of the Superintendent and I ask the Mayor how we begin that process.

Mr. Ruggiero - What is the time table for addressing the scheduling issue at Medford High School?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We have a contract in place for three years, which maintains the separate schedules and must be upheld. We want to maintain the integrity of vocational training, and we need to carefully negotiate that with the union.

Mr. Ruggiero - Do you anticipate pushback?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - When you propose a change, someone experiences loss.

Initially there may be some loss, but I am thinking about the students and offering them as many opportunities as possible.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Before the end of the year can the school committee receive a comprehensive report from the team about security improvements?

Mr. Ruseau - You mentioned policies to be updated. Will we need to approve the changes?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - You have brought some outdated policies online to my attention. We are

working to update those policies online.

Mr. Ruseau - I have heard there is a data person in every building in other districts. Will that be addressed in the budget?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We are trying to consistently progress-monitor. We did not have data aligned across the schools. We

have been working to bring coherence and alignment so we have consistent data to make

strategic, informed decisions.

Mr. Ruseau - The middle school schedule is different every day. Is there discussion around the variable schedule?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - That was brought to my attention. It is something I am willing to look at. The middle school schedules are now aligned

with each other. This is on my radar, but it will involve negotiating with the teachers union.

Motion to accept and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion

passes.

Condolences - Helen Mulligan, Violet Mercuri, Madeline Sloane, Irving Greenblatt.

Motion to adjourn offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 8:46PM.